

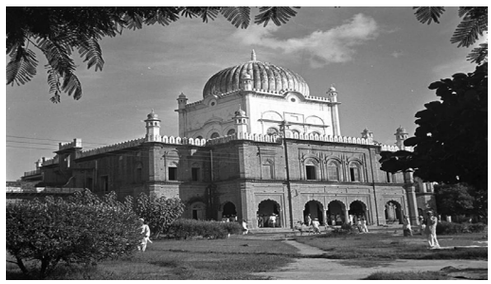
Hiuen Tsang visited Nalanda in the seventh century AD (CE). At that time students there studied the Vedas and were trained in fine arts, medicine, mathematics, astronomy, politics and the art of warfare. UNESCO declared the excavated remains at Nalanda in the list of World Heritage in 2009.

Education in Medieval India

Temples functioned as a place for imparting formal education during the medieval period. In small villages temple priest taught the pupils. Education imparted at a more advanced level was in colleges attached to the large temples. Mutts or monasteries also emerged as centres of learning in medieval period. Saivite and Vaishnavite mutts received royal patronage in the form of endowments. The education these mutts focused was on Saivism, Vaishnavism, martial arts, music and painting. These mutts continued to exist and the Tamil savant U.V. Saminathar pursued his learning in Tiruvaduthurai Saivite mutt that was established in the fourteenth century.

Technical education remained with guilds. Knowledge of mining, metallurgy, weaving, dyeing, carpentry was the preserve of the relevant guild. The sons of artisans were trained in hereditary occupations. These guilds functioned separately and there was no exchange of knowledge between these guilds and the educational centres.

During the sultanate and the Mughal rule, unlike the Sanskrit schools that catered to the upper and ruling classes, Islamic schools (*Maktabs*) were open to all without restriction. Here pupils in addition to memorising portions of the Quran also learnt vernacular and Persian. In the *Madrasas*, (Arabic institutions of higher learning) a poor student coming from a far off place could get the necessities of life from a pious family in the neighbourhood. *Madrasas* functioned as a theological seminary and law school. Curriculum centred on the Quran and the Hadith. In addition students were taught Arabic grammar, literature, arithmetic and accounting, logic.



Madrasa

English East India Company and Modern English Education

The concern for Indian education was first shown by Governor General Warren Hastings. Responding to a delegation of leading Muslims headed by a *maulvi*, he facilitated the establishment of a *Madrasa* at Calcutta in 1780-'81. There were forty stipendiary students studying there. In the next decade (1791-'92) with the support of his successor Cornwallis, Jonathan Duncan, later governor of Bombay, founded a Sanskrit college at Banaras at the cost of government. Thereafter for twenty years the government did not accept direct responsibility for education. Educational funds continued to be spent for many years on oriental learning. English Parliament while renewing the East India Company's Charter in 1813 included a clause to provide 'not less than one lakh of rupees' for the promotion of literature and sciences in British territories in India. But the money earmarked for the purpose remained unspent.

Meanwhile thanks to the initiative of social reformer Raja Rammohan Roy, the Hindu College was founded in Calcutta with local subscription in 1817. The purpose was to

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